QUILLBOOK · CUSTOMER SIMULATION · TEAM 08

Protect continuity. Earn the renewal.

Two decisions. Five scenarios.
A customer model built around real constraints and private advice.

WHAT HAPPENED · WHEN WE ACTED

Two crises.
One known January transition.

W3 — Unexpected incident

Payroll delays

Scale and cause initially unknown.

W4 — Incident update

Deposits recovered

Roughly 1 in 20 payroll clients affected.

W5 — Our first decision

Prepare early

Staffing, testing and a smaller price rise.

W7 — Unexpected crisis

Government shutdown

IRS phone help becomes unavailable.

W8 — Our second decision

Update + response

Senate funding vote; hotline, alerts and commission.

W9 — Known from the start

January transition

Scheduled tax / 1099 changes and renewal pressure.

WHY INTERVENTION MATTERED

January combines price pressure with operational dependence.

4,000

Annual plans due for renewal in weeks 9–10.

Continuity is the decision context

Payroll, filing preparation and the known transition create practical switching constraints.

The shutdown adds uncertainty and removes access to IRS phone help.

FIVE-RUN COMPARISON · ANNUAL PLANS DUE IN WEEKS 9–10

Renewal improves. The 92% goal remains ahead.



+2.75–4.38 pp

Renewal gain against matched no-decision runs.

SCENARIO	CHURN %*	PARTNER Δ	SUPPORT H*
Plan · 42	0.329	0.52	5.67
Plan · 43	0.074	0.55	5.66
No decisions · 42	0.210	0.21	8.00
No decisions · 43	0.062	0.00	8.06
Plan · no surprises	0.450	0.65	5.79

* Churn: peak 4-week departure rate. Support: peak weighted mean hours, excluding Jan 4–5. Partner Δ: change on a 1–5 scale.

EXACTLY TWO LOCKED PACKAGES

Prepare operations. Then support the advisers.

Week 5 · $950k

+10% renewal increase, 40 support staff for six weeks, and outside testing.

Why: prepare for the known week-9 transition while limiting price pressure on 4,000 upcoming renewals.

Week 8 · $430k

Accountant hotline, incident reports/texts, and a 20% commission for six months.

Why: support advisers during the shutdown, when IRS phone help was unavailable.

> $1.38M committed / $1.5M budget · $120k unspent · no decision slots left.

TIMING AND TRADEOFFS

We acted in week 5 for a risk arriving in week 9.

Preparation before the transition

Staffing and testing need lead time. A smaller renewal increase reduces simultaneous price pressure.

Tradeoff: $450k to limit renewal price pressure during the transition.

Week 8 responds to the shutdown

Direct help and incident reporting equip accountants to advise clients. Commission aims to protect the relationship.

Tradeoff: $300k for partner commission to support the adviser relationship.

DISTRIBUTION LOGIC · BEFORE BEHAVIOR

Equal voices. Different population weights.

24 voices cover three roles



42,000 businesses + **3,100** accountants.

Business weights: 25,400 owner-led + 16,600 bookkeeper-led. Adviser-managed clients stay inside the 42,000.

Choices are distributions

Each cohort returns behavior shares; population weights turn those shares into aggregate outcomes.

Alex Morgan and Sofia Lindqvist also carry two migration-flexibility perspectives, with assumed 50/50 shares.

Preserve the dossier totals

18,000 payroll users, 21,000 annual plans and 4,000 due renewals. Contrasting traits provide coverage; the LLM chooses behavior.

Relationships preserve reach

30 advisory pairs + 24 peer pairs. Every accountant links to owners and bookkeepers; each business cohort has at most three advisers.

OUR CREATIVE MODELING CHOICE

Personas have tensions, authority and memory.

Role & authority
Owners approve; bookkeepers recommend; accountants advise.

Operational exposure
1099, wage adjustments and payroll tax are distinct.

Trait tensions
Price, cash pressure, patience, forgiveness and uncertainty.

Practical capacity
Technical comfort, migration friction and workflow dependencies.

Information habits
Source checking, channels and social susceptibility.

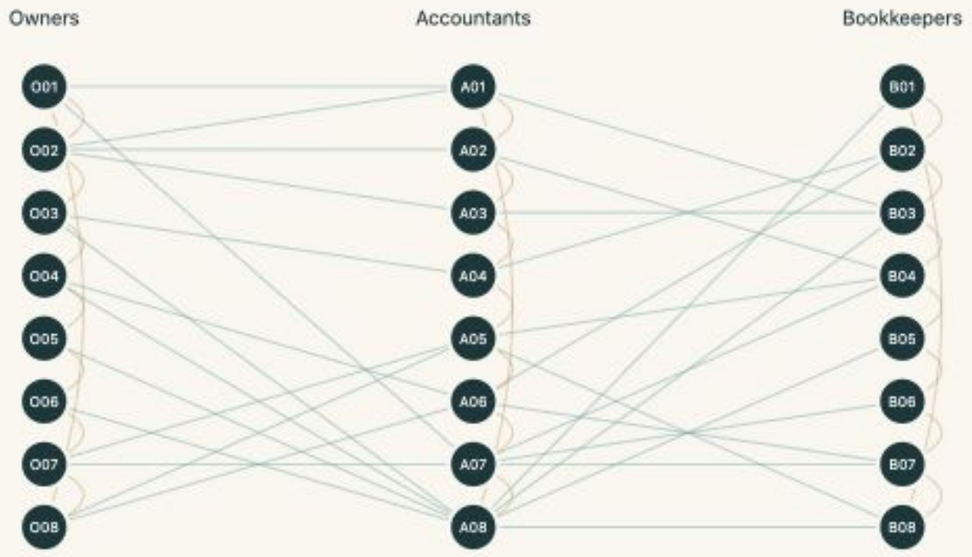
Business context
Sector, size, plan, payroll and portfolio weights.

Within-cohort variation
Behavior shares vary; selected profiles add flexibility segments.

Evolving memory
Weekly choices, conversations and commitments persist.

24 VOICES · 54 RECIPROCAL RELATIONSHIPS

Advice travels through relationships.



Teal · adviser/client Gold · peers 30 advisory + 24 peer pairs

Observe and send

↓

Route private messages

↓

Reply and choose

↓

Update weekly memory

WEEKLY SUPPORT · BOTH MATCHED SEEDS

Support improves. The 4h goal still slips.



Partner satisfaction improves in both plan seeds.

Churn is slightly higher in both matched comparisons.

* Weekly peak of the daily population-weighted mean response time; Jan 4–5 excluded. Synthetic support proxy.

WITH MORE TIME

Test the expensive assumptions.

Separate the package effects

Compare staffing/testing alone with the price concession; isolate commission from hotline and reporting.

Stress the customer model

Vary within-cohort shares, exposure and network structure; add matched seeds.

Calibrate the operational proxies

Use actual arrival rates, handle times and queue data to test whether 4h is feasible.

Validate behavior

Compare persona reasoning and renewal choices with customer interviews or observed data.